

Sicily & Rome

Miller Family · 2026

June 19 – July 3, 2026 · 15 Days

Jeff & Katie · Jake & Julia · Bev & Mary Jo · Rich · Scott (Sicily + Rome night)

Phase	Dates	Where	Who
1 · Arrival	Jun 19–20	Boston → Palermo	All 8
2 · Villa Minerva	Jun 20–24	Mondello, Palermo	All 8
3 · Al Jafar	Jun 24–28	Paceco, Trapani	All 8
4 · Rome	Jun 28–Jul 1	Via Veneto apartment	7 (Scott departs Jun 29)
5 · Florence	Jul 1–3	Sina Villa Medici	Bev & Mary Jo
Fly Home	Jul 1 & Jul 3	FCO→BOS / FLR→FCO→BOS	Staggered departures

✓ = confirmed booking · ! = still needed · ■■ = important reminder

PHASE 01

Departure Day

Friday June 19 · Boston → Rome → Palermo

1

DAY

Friday

June 19

Depart Boston

BOS → FCO → PMO

- 5:05pm ● ✓ **AZ615 BOS → FCO** · ITA Airways
- 7:05am+1 ● ✓ Arrive Rome FCO · Plaza Premium Lounge T1 (Priority Pass) · ~2hr layover
- 10:20am ● ✓ **AZ1785 FCO → PMO** · Arrive Palermo 11:30am

PHASE 02

Villa Minerva · Mondello, Palermo

June 20–24 · North Coast Sicily

2

DAY

Saturday

June 20

Arrival & Villa Minerva

Palermo Airport · Rental cars · Mondello · Groceries

Monreale option — Bev & Mary Jo (Saturday morning): While Jeff collects Rich from Hotel Tonic (~2pm), Bev & MJ can visit Monreale Cathedral — greatest Norman mosaic cycle in the world. Open 9am–5:30pm, ~20 min from villa. Rejoin by 2pm.

- 7:30am ● **Rich** arrives PMO → Hotel Tonic, Via Mariano Stabile 126, Palermo (rest until ~2pm).
- 11:30am ● ✓ Land PMO. Pick up rental cars — **Jeff: Avis #07172221US0** · **Bev: Avis #1198342794**
- ~2:00pm ● Collect Rich at Hotel Tonic. **Grocery stop — Eurospar** (Centro Olimpo, on route): eggs ×24, bread, butter, jam, cereal, yogurt, milk, coffee, fruit, snacks, water ×4 six-packs. Wine case pre-ordered to villa.
- 4:00pm ● ✓ Check in — **Villa Minerva**, Via Lugano 7, Mondello. Pool, gardens, settle in.
- 5:55pm ● **Scott** arrives PMO — own rental, makes own way to villa.
- 8:00pm ● ✓ Private cook dinner — cook arrives 6pm, dinner at 8pm

3

DAY

Sunday

June 21

Palermo Self-Guided Walking Tour

Morning walk · Casual lunch · Afternoon rest · Evening return

- 9:30am ● Drive to Palermo (~25 min). Park: Parcheggio del Centrostorico, Via Rossini 14. ■■■ Do NOT drive into historic centre.

- 10:00am ● **Quattro Canti & Fontana Pretoria · Palermo Cathedral · Mercato Ballarò**
- 1:00pm ● ✓ **Casual lunch — Nino u'Ballerino** · Traditional tavola calda, no reservation. (Moltivolti Google booking ID 0362-4B81-C9BE-7083 kept as backup — cancel via Google if not using)
- ~2:30pm ● Return to Villa Minerva. Pool afternoon.
- 6:00pm ● Head back to Palermo — city comes alive at night.
- 7:00pm ● ✓ **Dinner · Ristorante Quattro Mani** ✓ confirmed through Scott

■ **Ristorante Quattro Mani** ✓

Via Francesco Riso 3, Palermo · quattromaniristorante.it · +39 091 616 5046

Confirmed through Scott · Seafood, truffle ravioli, citrus swordfish

4

DAY

Monday

June 22

Cefalù Day Trip

Norman cathedral · Sandy beach · Seafront lunch · Mondello dinner

- 9:30am ● Drive ~1 hr to Cefalù. Park along Lungomare seafront (free).
- 10:30am ● **Duomo di Cefalù** — UNESCO Norman cathedral, Christ Pantocrator mosaic. ~45 min.
- 11:15am ● Medieval lanes · almond granita & brioche · down to the beach.
- 1:00pm ● ✓ **Lunch · SeaView Restaurant** ✓ — confirmed for 8 (TheFork), 1pm
- 2:30pm ● Browse corso — ceramics & lemon products. Drive back toward Mondello (~1 hr).
- 7:30pm ● ✓ **Dinner · Corallo — Cucina D'amare** ✓ — confirmed for 8 (TheFork), 7:30pm · Mondello seafront, 5 min from villa

■ **Corallo — Cucina D'amare** ✓

V.le Regina Elena, 75, 90149 Mondello · TheFork confirmed · 8 people · 7:30pm · 5 min from villa

■ **SeaView Restaurant** ✓

Cefalù seafront · TheFork confirmed · 8 people · 1pm lunch

■ **Il Cambusone (Scott's backup)**

Piazza Sant'Andrea 4, Palermo · Scott has separate reservation · +39 091 683 2099

5

DAY

Tuesday

June 23

Castellammare del Golfo

Guidaloca beach · Arab-Norman castle · Split dinner

- 9:15am ● Depart Villa Minerva. ~25 min via SS187 coastal road. 2 cars.
- 9:45am ● **Guidaloca Beach** — crystal clear water, pebble beach. Free access. Lido Vida Loca optional (~€15–20pp).
- 12:30pm ● Drive ~15 min into Castellammare town.
- 1:00pm ● ✓ **Lunch · H 80 Fame** ✓ — confirmed via WhatsApp (Jeff) for 8 at 1pm. Best seafood in town.
- 2:30pm ● Optional: Castello Arabo-Normanno (Tue 10am–1pm & 3–7pm) · Optional: Riserva Naturale dello Zingaro (~15 min).
- 5:30pm ● Return to villa. Pool and freshen up.
- 7:30pm ● ✓ **Jeff & Katie — Bye Bye Blues** ✓ · Michelin-starred · Via del Garofalo 23 · Res #683 · 7:30pm for 2

7:00pm ● ✓ **Rest of group (6) — Poldo 2 Mondello ✓** · Via Torre di Mondello 22c · 7pm · confirmed

PHASE 03

Al Jafar Castle Villa · Paceco

June 24–28 · Trapani, Erice & Favignana

6

DAY

Wednesday

June 24

Segesta & Transfer to Al Jafar

Greek temples · Check out Minerva · Check in Al Jafar

Rich & Scott head directly to Agrigento — skipping Segesta & La Locanda. Rejoin full group in Trapani June 25.

- 10:00am ● **Check out Villa Minerva.** Remaining: Jeff, Katie, Jake, Julia, Mary Jo, Bev.
- 11:00am ● ✓ **Parco Archeologico di Segesta ✓** · Confirmation **HYTTKVY8** · 11am · 4 people · 5th-c. BC Doric temple & theatre. Shuttle up €2.50. Allow 2–2.5 hrs.
- 1:15pm ● Lunch option: La Locanda di Nonna Ciccina, Calatafimi — not booked, call +39 0924 527370 for 4 if wanted.
- ~2:30pm ● Drive to Al Jafar (~40 min) · Contrada Castellaccio, 91027 Paceco.
- 4:00pm ● ✓ **Check in — Al Jafar** · Historic Arab-Norman castle villa · Walled gardens · 18m pool
- 8:00pm ● ✓ **Private cook dinner at Al Jafar** (cook arrives 6pm)

■ **Al Jafar — Confirmed Cook Menu ✓**

Starter: Bruschetta with fresh tomato & basil

Pasta: Seafood risotto — no cream, no milk, no shrimp (lactose-free) · Main: Sardine meatballs with mint & tomato · Dessert: Cannoli with ricotta

7

DAY

Thursday

June 25

Trapani & Erice

Medieval hilltop town · Cable car · Salt pans · Full group reunites

- 9:30am ● Depart Al Jafar. ~15 min to Trapani. Park near cable car.
- 10:00am ● **Trapani-Erice Funivia cable car** — €11 return, 10–15 min. Opens 9:30am Thu. ■■ Can close in high winds.
- 10:15am ● **Erice** — medieval hilltop town, Castello di Venere, limestone lanes, views to Tunisia.
- 11:30am ● ■ Almond pastries & granita — non-negotiable Erice stop.
- 1:00pm ● ✓ **Lunch · Osteria di Venere ✓** — confirmed via WhatsApp · 1pm · sit-down Sicilian seafood in the hilltop village
- 2:45pm ● Cable car back down to Trapani.
- 3:00pm ● **Saline di Trapani** — salt pans & windmills scenic drive. Scott explores Trapani independently, meets for dinner.
- 7:00pm ● ✓ **Dinner · Locanda Botteghelle ✓** · confirmed for 8 (full group incl. Rich & Scott)

■ **Locanda Botteghelle Ristorante Enoteca ✓**

Corso Vittorio Emanuele 154, Trapani · +39 0923 569685 · confirmed for 8 · ~15 min from Al Jafar

8

DAY

Friday

June 26

Favignana — Egadi Islands

Hydrofoil · Tuk tuks · Cala Azzurra · Island lunch · Bromu dinner

✓ **Liberty Lines hydrofoil CONFIRMED** — e-tickets for all 8. Departs 9:30am, returns 4:30pm. Save to phone before departure day.

- 9:00am ● Depart Al Jafar. ~15 min to Trapani port. Park near Liberty Lines, Via Ammiraglio Staiti 55–61.
- 9:30am ● ✓ **Hydrofoil Trapani → Favignana ✓** · 30 min crossing · e-tickets confirmed all 8
- 10:00am ● Arrive Favignana. Hire 2 Ape tuk tuks at port — agree fare first.
- 10:15am ● **Cala Azzurra** — finest sandy beach, turquoise & calm, great for kids. No service — bring water & snacks. Mary Jo likely explores Favignana town independently.
- 12:15pm ● Tuk tuk back. Stop at **Cala Rossa** — dramatic rocky cove, great photo stop.
- 1:00pm ● Casual street food / lunch in Favignana town — no reservation. Regroup with Mary Jo.
- 2:30pm ● Explore town, gelato, tuna shops. Back to port.
- 4:30pm ● ✓ **Hydrofoil Favignana → Trapani ✓** · e-tickets confirmed
- 7:00pm ● ✓ **Dinner · Bromu Restaurant, Trapani ✓** · confirmed for 8 through Scott

■ **Bromu Restaurant ✓**

Viale Regina Elena 10, 91100 Trapani · confirmed through Scott · 7pm · 8 people

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DAY

Saturday

June 27

Selinunte & La Foresteria Planeta Estate

Quiet villa morning · Selinunte 4pm · Farewell Sicily dinner

- Morning ● Quiet last morning at Al Jafar — last swim, pack, gardens. Last breakfast. Leave ~3pm.
- 4:00pm ● ✓ **Selinunte Archaeological Park ✓** · 4pm entry tickets confirmed (in email) · One of Europe's largest Greek temple parks · Electric cart €17/person · Allow 2–2.5 hrs
- ~6:30pm ● Leave Selinunte. Drive ~45 min toward Menfi — La Foresteria Planeta Estate.
- 7:30pm ● ✓ **La Foresteria Planeta Estate ✓** · Farewell Sicily dinner · confirmed through Jeff · Planeta winery, Agrigento hills · SP79 Km 91, 92013 Menfi AG

■ **La Foresteria Planeta Estate ✓**

SP79, Km 91, Contrada Passo di Gurra, 92013 Menfi AG · Sat Jun 27 · 7:30pm · Confirmed through Jeff

One of Sicily's great wine estates · ~1hr 15min from Al Jafar

PHASE 04

Rome — Via Veneto Apartment

June 28 – July 1 · The Eternal City

10

DAY

Sunday

June 28

Palermo → Rome

Return cars · All 8 fly AZ1784 · Via Veneto apartment

- 9:30am ● Check out Al Jafar. All 8 together.
- 10:30am ● ✓ Arrive Palermo Airport (PMO). **Return Avis rental cars by 12:00pm** (#1198342651 & #1198342794)
- 12:15pm ● ✓ **ITA AZ1784 PMO → FCO** · All 8 passengers · Arrives 1:15pm
- ~1:30pm ● ✓ Confirmed private transfer FCO → apartment ✓ · **€110 cash to driver**
- 2:00pm ● ✓ Check in — **Roma Prestigious Apartment, Via Veneto** · from 2pm · Scott on sofa bed tonight only (departs Monday)
- Afternoon ● Freshen up · stroll Via Veneto · Trevi Fountain (10 min walk) · aperitivo.
- 6:30pm ● ✓ **Dinner · Ristorante Life** ✓ · 8 people · confirmed through Scott

■ Ristorante Life ✓

Via della Vite, 28, 00187 Roma · Sun Jun 28 · 6:30pm · 8 people · Confirmed through Scott

11

DAY

Monday

June 29

Ancient Rome

Colosseum · Roman Forum · Palatine · Scott departs · Dinner for 7

- 9:00am ● ✓ **Colosseum, Roman Forum & Palatine Hill** ✓ · Guided tour · 3 hrs · 5 adults + 2 kids · \$483.46 · Viator confirmed · Wear comfortable shoes, bring water
- 12:00pm ● Tour ends. Lunch near the Forum or Testaccio.
- Afternoon ● Capitoline Hill → Circus Maximus → Bocca della Verità → Trastevere stroll
- 7:30pm ● ✓ **Dinner · Girarrosto Fiorentino** ✓ · 7:30pm · 7 people

■ Girarrosto Fiorentino ✓

Via Sicilia, 46, 00187 Roma · Mon Jun 29 · 7:30pm · 7 people

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DAY

Tuesday

June 30

Last Day in Rome

Group splits · Castel Sant'Angelo · Vatican · Pantheon area

Jeff, Katie, Jake, Julia & Rich

- 9:30am ● ✓ **Castel Sant'Angelo** ✓ · 5 tickets confirmed (in email) · fortress, cannons, dungeons, rooftop · Allow 2 hrs
- 11:30am ● Walk Ponte Sant'Angelo → Piazza Navona (~25 min scenic)
- ~1pm ● Lunch near Pantheon area · Stroll past Pantheon exterior · Piazza della Rotonda
- Afternoon ● Trevi Fountain → Come il Latte gelato (5 min from apt, rated 4.7)

Mary Jo & Bev

- 8:15am ● ✓ **Vatican Museums, Sistine Chapel & St. Peter's** ✓
Skip-the-Line Guided Tour · Viator #1736906741
Meet: Via Germanico 8, Roma · ~3 hrs
- ~12pm ● Lunch in Prati neighbourhood near Vatican
- Afternoon ● Piazza Navona (15 min walk) · Reconnect with Jeff's group

Evening ● ✓ **Dinner · Fraschetta** ✓ · 7 people · Via dei Cappuccini 29 · confirmed

■ **Fraschetta** ✓

Via dei Cappuccini, 29, Roma · Tue Jun 30 · 7 people · confirmed · Tagliatelle al tartufo, pistachio tiramisù · Rated 4.6

PHASE 05

Departures & Florence

July 1–3 · Fly home · Bev & Mary Jo: Sina Villa Medici

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DAY

Wednesday

July 1

Departures

Rome → Boston · Bev & Mary Jo train to Florence

Departure transfer ✓ — Private transfer apartment → FCO · Confirmed through apartment booking · Pickup **7:30am** · **€100 cash to driver** · Jeff, Katie, Jake, Julia + Rich

Jeff, Katie, Jake, Julia	Rich	Mary Jo & Bev
FCO → BOS ITA AZ614 10:25am → 1:40pm EDT	FCO → EWR Separate booking Rides to FCO with Jeff's group	Roma → Firenze SMN Italo ✓ BOOKED 10:55am → 12:31pm Check in: Sina Villa Medici

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DAY

Thursday

July 2

Florence — Uffizi, Accademia & Last Evening

Booked guided tour · Michelangelo's David · Early night

- 10:15am ● ✓ **Uffizi & Accademia + Small Group Duomo Walking Tour** ✓ · Viator #1698207435 · 2 Seniors · \$305.60 · Meet Via Guelfa 2, Firenze
- Afternoon ● Oltrarno neighbourhood · gelato · rest at Sina Villa Medici.
- 7:00pm ● Early dinner near hotel.

Evening

- ■■ Ask hotel concierge to arrange taxi to FLR for 4:30am — AZ1676 departs 6:25am.

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DAY

Friday

July 3

Florence → Rome → Boston

Ultra-early departure · FLR → FCO → BOS

- ~4:30am ● Pre-arranged taxi from Sina Villa Medici → Florence Airport (FLR). Allow 30 min.
- 6:25am ● ✓ **AZ1676 FLR → FCO** · ITA Airways · arrives 7:15am
- 10:25am ● ✓ **AZ614 FCO → BOS** · ITA Airways · arrives 1:40pm EDT

Villa Quick Reference

	Villa Minerva	Al Jafar	Sina Villa Medici
Dates	Jun 20–24	Jun 24–28	Jul 1–3
Who	All 8	All 8	Bev & Mary Jo
Address	Via Lugano 7 Mondello, Palermo	Contrada Castellaccio 91027 Paceco (TP)	Via il Prato 42 50123 Florence
Pool	✓ Private outdoor	✓ 18m private	Hotel pool
Parking	On-site	On-site grounds	City hotel — taxi in
Note	Grocery run on arrival (Eurospar en route)	Check-in 4pm Check-out 10am	✓ Confirmed Book taxi night before

Flight Summary

Flight	Route	Date / Departs	Arrives	Who
AZ615	BOS → FCO	Jun 19 · 5:05pm	Jun 20 · 7:05am	All 8
AZ1785	FCO → PMO	Jun 20 · 10:20am	11:30am	All 8
AZ1784	PMO → FCO	Jun 28 · 12:15pm	1:15pm	All 8
AZ614	FCO → BOS	Jul 1 · 10:25am	1:40pm EDT	Jeff, Katie, Jake, Julia, Rich
Italo	Roma → Firenze SMN	Jul 1 · 10:55am	12:31pm	Bev & Mary Jo
AZ1676	FLR → FCO	Jul 3 · 6:25am	7:15am	Bev & Mary Jo
AZ614	FCO → BOS	Jul 3 · 10:25am	1:40pm EDT	Bev & Mary Jo

Open Items

Status	Item
! BOOK	Selinunte — confirmed, tickets in email ✓ (double-check)
! ARRANGE	Airport taxi FLR for 4:30am Jul 3 — ask Sina Villa Medici concierge on arrival
! OPTIONAL	La Locanda di Nonna Ciccina, Calatafimi — call +39 0924 527370 if group wants Jun 24 lunch
! OPTIONAL	Cancel Moltivolti via Google (ID 0362-4B81-C9BE-7083) if not using Jun 21